

For whatever reason (perhaps because of society's negative emotional state and, as a result, its weakened physical state), communicable disease sometimes plays a prominent role in major corrective periods, with some Cycle and Supercycle degree corrections containing epidemics and larger ones pandemics. With war and epidemics possible, the coming crisis will almost certainly pertain not only to property, but to survival. Be sure to stay vigilant. There will be more physical danger in the next fifty-plus years than there was in the last fifty. The most dangerous time socially and politically will be during and for a few years after wave (C), whenever it occurs. One thing is for certain: Several years from now, following the market and watching financial television for the latest stock tip will have become less relevant to the average person's life. The next 10% move in the Dow will be far less important to most people, as their minds will be on other things.

Conflict is always with us, as are joy and harmony. For the most part, human progress and happiness prevail. Throughout even the major corrective periods of history, most people have lived normal and fulfilling lives while an unfortunate few have gotten caught up in the various social maelstroms that such periods produce. The main point of foreknowledge is to be prepared mentally so that you can recognize the geographical centers of physical conflict as they are brewing and act to avoid them if necessary. Forewarning can mean the difference between life and death, which is why this book is important even to non-investors.

With regard to specific upcoming events, junctures such as this in the long term wave structure portend virtually inconceivable social disruptions. In 1929, with the Dow at 381, who would have believed that in less than three years the Dow would fall 89% to 41, that in ten years war and holocaust would begin in Europe, that in twelve years aircraft would attack Pearl Harbor, that in twenty years (at the termination of the wave (IV) bear market in constant dollars), the most populous country in the world, as well as half of Europe, would be taken over by Communists? And who would have believed in 1949 that in forty more years (near the termination of wave V), the Communists would relinquish power and free these same countries? The spirit of each of these actions was consistent with the position of the wave structure at the time. Specifics, however, cannot be forecasted at the outset, only surmised. As the trends develop, more and more specifics can be anticipated, however, and plans can usually be formulated in time to avoid the trouble spots.